AEP FROM ZERO • PART 2 • SPEAK TO YOUR CUSTOMER (AJO)

EPISODE 22

Offer Decisioning in AJO: Eligibility & Ranking

What is offer decisioning in Adobe Journey Optimizer, and how do eligibility, ranking and fallback offers work together? In this AJO offer decisioning tutorial, Bloom stops giving everyone twenty percent: Kavya compares legacy Decision Management with the newer Decisioning, then builds decision items with audience eligibility, priority and capping, a collection, a selection strategy ranked by offer priority, and a decision policy with a fallback offer inside the win-back email. You will learn why Approve is what

Previously: Cart Rescue lets buyers leave

- Last time: Cart Rescue v1, built and tested
- Priya exits the moment she buys
- Rohan: a holdout from day one
- Today: who gets which offer, and why
- Tool: Decisioning in Adobe Journey Optimizer

KEY IDEA

Cart Rescue v1 listens, waits and lets buyers leave. Today's problem is margin: Bloom still gives almost everyone the same twenty percent.

Twenty percent for everyone

- Same email, same 20% off, twice a week
- Gold members get it too, and would buy anyway
- Unneeded discounts are margin given away
- Lapsed: a reason to return. Gold: a thank-you
- Everyone else: something useful, never a gap

KEY IDEA

Bloom gives the same twenty percent to customers who need a nudge and to loyal Gold members who would buy anyway. That is margin walking out.

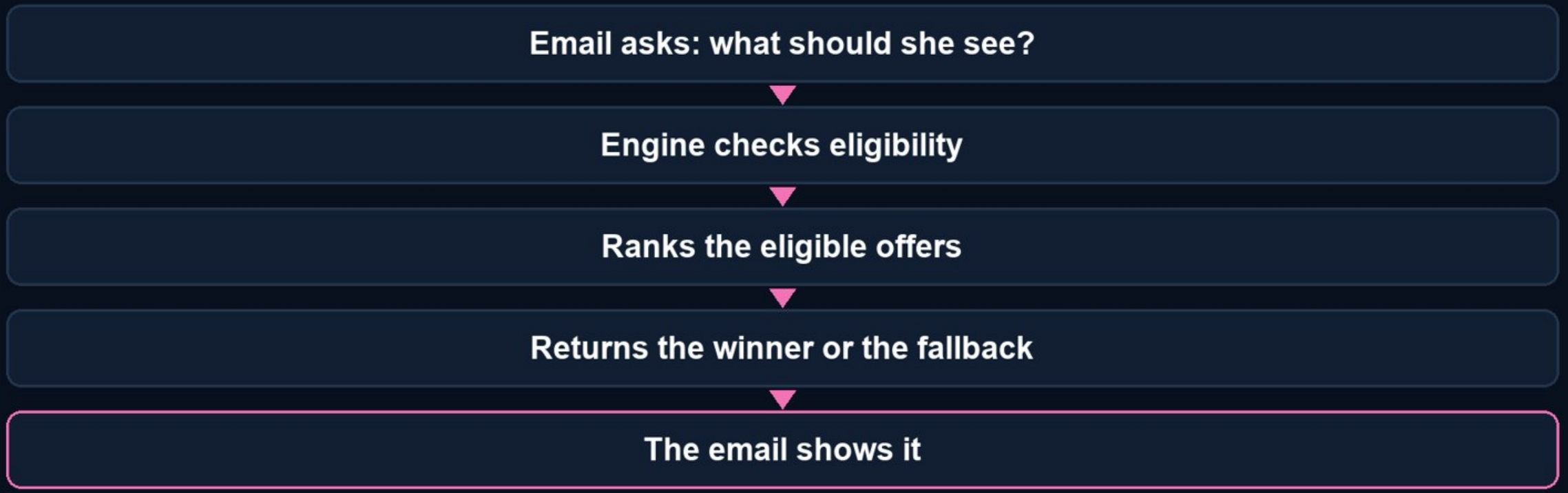
Offer, eligibility, ranking, fallback

Word	Question it answers	Bloom example
Offer	What could we say?	20% Comeback
Eligibility	Who may see it?	Lapsed 90 only
Ranking	Which eligible offer wins?	Comeback above Early Access
Fallback	What if nothing qualifies?	Free Shipping

KEY IDEA

An offer is what you could say. Eligibility is who may see it. Ranking picks the winner among the eligible. The fallback shows when nothing qualifies.

A library is not a decision



KEY IDEA

Decisioning moves offer logic out of the email into a governed library. The email asks one question, and the engine answers person by person.

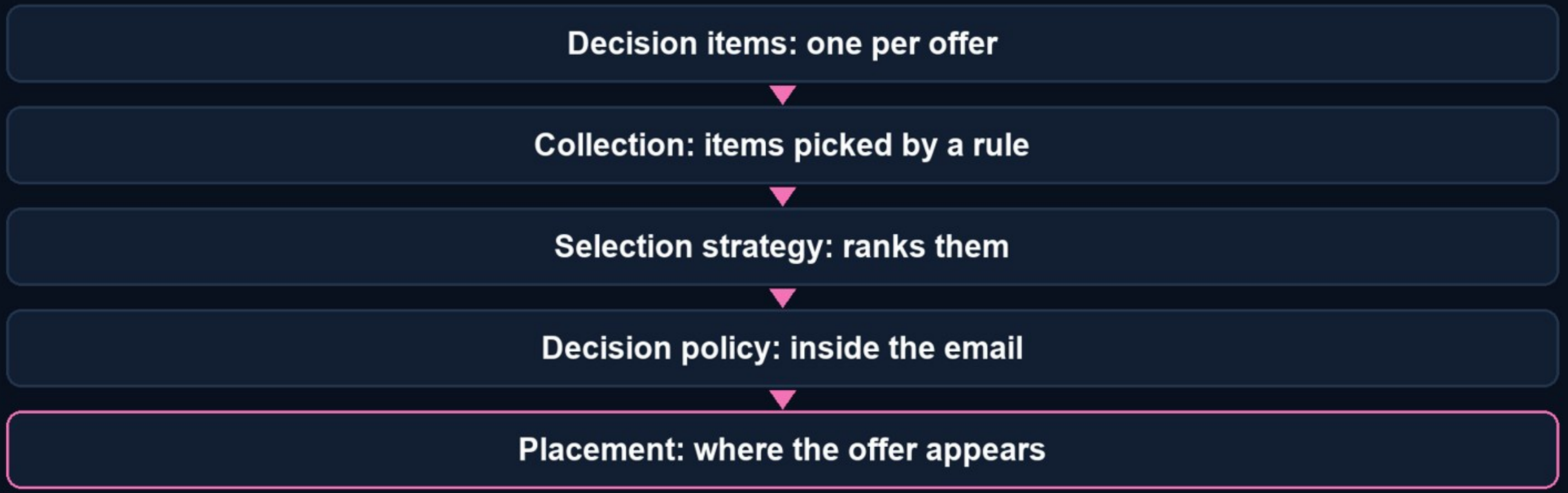
Decision Management versus Decisioning

	Decision Management	Decisioning
Adobe calls it	Legacy	Next-generation framework
Menu	Offers, Components	Catalogs, Strategy setup
Offer unit	Personalized offer	Decision item in Offers
Grouping	Collection qualifiers	Collections built by rules
The logic	A decision	Strategy in a decision policy

KEY IDEA

AJO shows two offer systems. Decision Management carries a Legacy badge; Decisioning is Adobe's next-generation framework. Recognise both.

Bloom's build on the whiteboard



KEY IDEA

Before any clicking, Divya mapped the offers onto Decisioning's objects: items, a collection, a selection strategy, a decision policy and a placement.

Creating a decision item

- Decisioning, Catalogs: one catalog, Offers
- Create item: Attributes, Eligibility, Review
- Offer name required; Priority starts at 1
- Higher priority wins among eligible items
- Image and text come from custom attributes
- Edit schema changes the form sandbox-wide

KEY IDEA

Catalogs, then Create item. Offer name is required, Priority starts at 1 and higher wins. An item's image and text come from catalog custom attributes.

Eligibility: audience or decision rule?

Eligibility	How it works	Use it when
All visitors	No restriction	The offer suits anyone
Audiences	Computed earlier	A little delay is fine
By rule	Checked at each decision	It must be true right now

KEY IDEA

An item is eligible to All visitors, to audiences computed earlier, or by a decision rule checked again every time a decision is made.

Capping and status: Draft is never served

Status	What it means
Draft	Saved, but never served
Approved	Available to the decision engine
Archived	Retired; it can never come back

Capping: up to 10 rules per item; counters reset at midnight UTC

KEY IDEA

Capping limits how often an offer is shown. Items move from Draft to Approved to Archived, and only Approved items are ever served.

Collections and the selection strategy

Ranking method	How the winner is chosen
Offer priority	Highest Priority among eligible items
Formula	A score you write yourself
AI model	Learns from impressions and clicks

Bloom chose Offer priority: no offer history yet

KEY IDEA

A collection picks items by rule. A selection strategy adds optional eligibility and a ranking method: Offer priority, Formula or AI model.

Three places eligibility can sit

Layer	Set where	Bloom's choice
The item	Create offer item	Lapsed 90 or Gold Members
The strategy	Selection strategy	All visitors
The campaign	Its own audience	Lapsed 90 for Win-Back

KEY IDEA

Eligibility can sit on the item, the selection strategy, or the campaign or journey's own audience. A rule that belongs to the offer goes on the item.

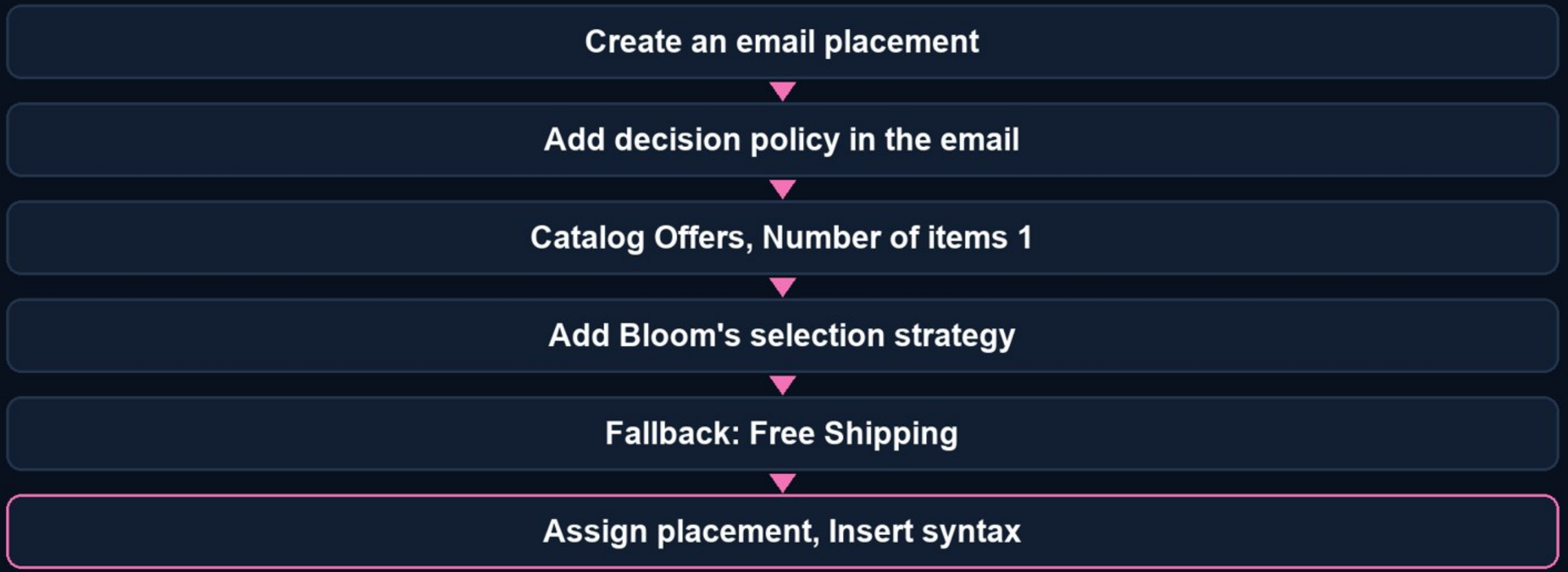
The switch that wipes an email

- Campaign, Content tab: Enable decisioning
- The switch sits next to Content template
- Adobe: it clears existing email content
- Save the designed email as a template first
- Never flip it on someone else's email

KEY IDEA

Adobe says enabling decisioning clears existing email content. Save a finished email as a template first, and never flip the switch on someone else's email.

Decision policy, placement and fallback



KEY IDEA

Inside the email, a decision policy names the catalog, the number of items, the strategy sequence and the fallback. An email placement must exist first.

Approve, wait, then prove it

Test seat	State	Offer shown
Divya's seat	Lapsed	20% Comeback
Kavya's seat	Gold	Early Access Drop
Farhan's seat	Silver, recent buyer	Free Shipping
Lapsed and Gold	Both eligible	20% Comeback, ranked higher

Approve, then allow up to 15 minutes before testing

KEY IDEA

Anjali signs off, Divya clicks Approve, changes take up to fifteen minutes, and proofs rendered for the team's seats show each offer where eligibility says.

Interview corner: say it in one sentence

- “A library is not a decision.”
- Decisioning needs eligibility, ranking, fallback
- Campaign: what do we send?
- Journey: what happens to her next?
- Decisioning: which offer does she see?

KEY IDEA

A library is not a decision. Decisioning needs eligibility, ranking and a fallback, and it lives inside the message a campaign or journey sends.

Recap, your question, and the next worry

- Eligibility filters, ranking chooses, fallback fills
- Only Approved items are ever served
- Template first, then Enable decisioning
- Practice: 20 approved offers, none shown. Why?
- Next: caps, quiet hours, suppression, consent

KEY IDEA

Eligibility filters, ranking chooses, the fallback fills the slot, and only Approved items are served. Next: the guardrails that keep Bloom welcome.